

# AcmeCorp Hard Policy Benchmark

Purpose: this synthetic company-policy handbook is intentionally harder than the normal demo document. It repeats similar policy terms across pages so base vector retrieval may confuse related sections. It is designed to test reranking in a realistic PolicyDoc AI workflow.

The document contains overlapping reimbursement rules, similar access-control clauses, parallel incident-reporting deadlines, multiple retention tables, and negative-answer traps.

| Page | Policy Area                                                          | Why it is hard for retrieval                                 |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Overview and benchmark map                                           | Contains many keywords that overlap with later pages.        |
| 2    | Meal and local expense reimbursement                                 | Normal meals, client meals, office supplies, and exclusions. |
| 3    | Travel reimbursement and travel meals                                | Similar wording to page 2 but different limits.              |
| 4    | Remote work, travel work, and equipment                              | Several work-location policies with overlapping terms.       |
| 5    | Access control and restricted documents                              | Many roles and similar document classes.                     |
| 6    | Temporary access and emergency access                                | Similar to access control but different approval rules.      |
| 7    | Retention policy for employee, vendor, finance, and security records | Multiple retention periods with similar language.            |
| 8    | Security incident reporting deadlines                                | Lost laptop, token, phishing, and exposure deadlines.        |
| 9    | Missing policy and negative-answer behavior                          | Refund, discount, salary, and bonus traps.                   |
| 10   | Evaluation guide for reranking                                       | Expected pages for hard benchmark questions.                 |

Recommended hard queries: maximum amount for a normal lunch claim, travel dinner reimbursement, temporary restricted access, missing security token reporting, closed security incident retention, and customer refund policy.

# 1. Local Expense and Meal Reimbursement Policy

Employees may claim local business expenses only when the expense is directly related to company work, has a valid receipt, and is submitted within 30 calendar days. The local meal rule applies to normal workday meals in the employee city, not to travel meals or client entertainment meals. Alcohol, personal snacks, and non-business entertainment are not reimbursable under this local policy.

| Expense Type              | Limit                  | Receipt Required             | Approval Rule                                | Important Exclusion                      |
|---------------------------|------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Local Meal / Normal Lunch | USD 25 per person      | Required for all claims      | Manager approval through expense portal      | Alcohol and personal snacks excluded     |
| Client Meal               | USD 60 per person      | Required with attendee names | Manager approval required before submission  | Must list customer or prospect attendees |
| Office Supplies           | USD 100 per month      | Required                     | Manager approval if over USD 50              | Personal home decor excluded             |
| Local Taxi/Rideshare      | Actual reasonable fare | Required                     | Allowed when public transport is impractical | Daily commute not reimbursable           |
| Team Celebration Snack    | USD 15 per person      | Required                     | Department head approval                     | Cannot be claimed as local meal          |

Important distinction: a normal lunch claim is the same as a local meal claim. It is capped at USD 25 per person. A client meal has a different limit and should not be used for ordinary employee lunch reimbursement.

## 2. Travel Reimbursement and Travel Meal Policy

Travel reimbursement applies only when an employee is on approved business travel outside the normal work city. These rules should not be confused with local expense reimbursement. Travel meals have higher limits because travel may require airport meals, overnight stays, or meals in high-cost cities.

| Travel Expense   | Standard Limit         | High-Cost City Limit   | Receipt Required | Notes                                    |
|------------------|------------------------|------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Travel Breakfast | USD 18 per person      | USD 25 per person      | Required         | Only during approved travel days         |
| Travel Lunch     | USD 35 per person      | USD 45 per person      | Required         | Not the same as local meal reimbursement |
| Travel Dinner    | USD 50 per person      | USD 70 per person      | Required         | Alcohol not reimbursable                 |
| Hotel            | USD 180 per night      | USD 250 per night      | Required         | Upgrades need pre-approval               |
| Airport Taxi     | Actual reasonable fare | Actual reasonable fare | Required         | Allowed for business travel only         |

If a question asks about a normal lunch, local meal, or ordinary workday meal, use page 2. If the question asks about business travel lunch or travel dinner, use this page.

### 3. Remote Work, Travel Work, and Equipment Policy

AcmeCorp supports hybrid work for roles that can maintain performance and confidentiality outside the office. Remote work is different from travel work. Remote work happens from an approved home or private workspace, while travel work happens during approved business travel.

| Policy Item            | Rule                                            | Employee Responsibility                                   | Approval Needed                  |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Regular Remote Work    | Up to 3 remote days per week for eligible roles | Maintain availability during 10:00-16:00 local core hours | Manager approval                 |
| Occasional Remote Work | Up to 5 one-off days per quarter                | Request before the workday starts                         | Manager approval                 |
| Travel Work            | Allowed only during approved business travel    | Use VPN and avoid public screen exposure                  | Travel approval already required |
| Company Laptop         | May be issued for approved roles                | Keep secure and report loss immediately                   | IT approval                      |
| Security Token         | Required for restricted systems                 | Do not share token or store with password                 | Security approval                |

Lost equipment rules are also repeated in the incident-reporting section. A question about how fast to report loss should use the incident deadline table, not this equipment overview.

## 4. Role-Based Access and Restricted Document Policy

Access to company information follows least privilege. Employees should access only the documents required for their current role, department, or project. Restricted documents include employee records, financial forecasts, customer data, security procedures, legal advice, vendor pricing, and unreleased business plans.

| Role                | Public Docs              | Internal Docs                 | Restricted Docs                 | Approval Needed               |
|---------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Employee            | Yes                      | Yes, department assigned only | No                              | Manager for department access |
| Manager             | Yes                      | Yes                           | Limited, project-specific       | Data owner approval           |
| HR Partner          | Yes                      | HR documents only             | Employee records only           | HR director approval          |
| Security Admin      | Yes                      | Yes                           | Yes, for security operations    | Security lead approval        |
| Finance Approver    | Yes                      | Finance documents only        | Budget and expense records only | Finance controller approval   |
| External Contractor | Public project docs only | Limited project docs          | No                              | Sponsor approval and NDA      |

If a question asks who can access restricted documents broadly, the best evidence is this role-based table. If it asks about temporary access, emergency access, or urgent incident access, use the next page.

## 5. Temporary and Emergency Access Policy

Temporary access is not the same as normal role-based access. It may be granted for short projects, audits, emergency response, or legal review. Temporary access must be time-limited and removed after the stated purpose ends.

| Access Type               | Maximum Duration    | Who Approves       | Required Evidence              | Review Rule                          |
|---------------------------|---------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Temporary Project Access  | 30 days             | Data owner         | Project ID and business reason | Review at expiration                 |
| Audit Access              | 14 days             | Compliance manager | Audit plan and scope           | Remove when audit closes             |
| Emergency Security Access | 72 hours            | Security lead      | Incident ticket number         | Review within 24 hours after closure |
| Legal Hold Access         | Until hold released | Legal counsel      | Legal hold notice              | Reviewed monthly                     |
| Vendor Support Access     | 7 days              | System owner       | Support ticket and NDA         | Disable immediately after support    |

A query about temporary restricted access should retrieve this page, not the general access table. This page intentionally repeats access and restricted document terms to make retrieval harder.

## 6. Document Retention and Compliance Review Policy

Business records must be retained according to category, legal relevance, and audit requirements. Employees should not delete records subject to investigation, litigation hold, audit, or regulatory review. Similar categories may have different retention periods.

| Record Category                  | Retention Period                | Owner             | Disposal Method                | Confusing Similar Category           |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Employee Records                 | 7 years after termination       | HR                | Secure deletion after approval | Employee drafts are not records      |
| Expense Reports                  | 5 years after fiscal year end   | Finance           | Finance archive purge          | Travel receipts follow expense rules |
| Closed Security Incident Records | 6 years after closure           | Security          | Compliance-approved deletion   | Open incidents must not be deleted   |
| Vendor Contracts                 | 7 years after contract end      | Legal/Procurement | Legal review before deletion   | Vendor emails may be general drafts  |
| General Drafts                   | 1 year if not business-critical | Document owner    | Owner deletion                 | Does not apply to legal hold         |

If a question asks about closed security incident records, answer 6 years after closure. Do not confuse it with employee records or vendor contracts, which also use seven-year language.

## 7. Security Incident Reporting Deadline Policy

Security, privacy, finance, and workplace incidents must be reported quickly. Employees should not investigate incidents independently if doing so may destroy evidence or expand exposure. Different incident types have different reporting deadlines.

| Incident Type                 | Report Within                      | Report To             | Required Details                                          |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Lost laptop or security token | Immediately, no later than 2 hours | Security Service Desk | Device ID, token ID, last known location, time discovered |
| Suspected phishing            | Within 4 hours                     | Security mailbox      | Email headers, sender, clicked links if any               |
| Customer data exposure        | Immediately                        | Security and Legal    | Affected system, data type, approximate record count      |
| Expense fraud concern         | Within 2 business days             | Finance Compliance    | Claim ID, employee name, supporting evidence              |
| Workplace safety incident     | Immediately for serious injury     | People Operations     | Location, people involved, emergency response status      |

Questions about missing laptops, lost devices, or security tokens should cite this page. The remote work page mentions equipment responsibility but does not contain the exact reporting deadline.



## 8. Missing Policy and Negative-Answer Behavior

The assistant must not invent policy details when the document does not contain them. Vector search always returns the closest chunks, even when none truly answer the question. The generation prompt should return an insufficient-context response for missing policies.

| User Question                           | Correct System Behavior                                                            | Reason                                                             |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What is the customer refund policy?     | Say the refund policy is not available in the provided documents.                  | This handbook contains employee policy, not customer refund terms. |
| What is the employee bonus percentage?  | Say the information is not available in the document.                              | The handbook does not define bonus percentages.                    |
| What is the product discount policy?    | Say the information is not available in the document.                              | No product discount policy is included.                            |
| What is the CEO travel allowance?       | Say the information is not available in the document.                              | No executive-specific travel policy is provided.                   |
| Can contractors access restricted docs? | Answer from access table: external contractors cannot access restricted documents. | This is present in the access policy.                              |

Negative-query testing is required because a compliance assistant must be safer than a generic chatbot. The safest behavior is to say that information is missing when retrieved evidence is weak or unrelated.

## 9. Hard Benchmark Evaluation Guide

This page defines expected evidence for the hard reranking benchmark. The questions are intentionally paraphrased to avoid simple keyword matching.

| Question Type      | Example Query                                                  | Expected Page | Expected Evidence                                                 |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Local meal limit   | What is the maximum amount for a normal lunch claim?           | 2             | Local Meal / Normal Lunch = USD 25 per person                     |
| Travel meal limit  | How much can be claimed for travel dinner in a high-cost city? | 3             | Travel Dinner high-cost city limit = USD 70 per person            |
| Remote work        | How many days can an eligible employee work from home weekly?  | 4             | Regular Remote Work = up to 3 remote days per week                |
| Restricted access  | Which role can access restricted security operation documents? | 5             | Security Admin can access restricted docs for security operations |
| Temporary access   | How long can emergency security access last?                   | 6             | Emergency Security Access = 72 hours                              |
| Retention          | How long are closed security incident records kept?            | 7             | Closed Security Incident Records = 6 years after closure          |
| Incident reporting | When must a missing security token be reported?                | 8             | Immediately, no later than 2 hours                                |
| Missing policy     | What is the customer refund policy?                            | 9             | Information not available in the provided documents               |

Reranking evaluation should compare base ChromaDB retrieval against ChromaDB candidate retrieval followed by cross-encoder reranking. If the correct page appears in candidates but not final top-k, reranking can improve MRR. If the correct page is not in the candidate set, reranking cannot recover it.

## 10. Dense Confuser Appendix

This appendix intentionally repeats terms from multiple sections. It exists to make semantic retrieval harder. A basic vector search may over-rank this appendix because it contains many policy keywords, but it is not usually the best evidence for specific questions.

Meal, reimbursement, travel, local meal, client meal, normal lunch, travel lunch, dinner, receipt, approval, finance, expense, and claim terms appear throughout the handbook. The precise limit depends on whether the question asks about local workday meals, client meals, or travel meals.

Access, restricted documents, temporary access, emergency access, legal hold, vendor support, security operations, employee records, finance records, and contractor access also overlap. The correct page depends on whether the query asks about normal role-based access, temporary access, or missing-policy behavior.

Incident, laptop, token, security, data exposure, phishing, customer data, lost device, and reporting deadline terms overlap with remote-work equipment rules. The exact reporting deadline is found in the incident-reporting table, not in the remote-work section.

This page should not be the top source for most specific questions. If it appears too often in retrieval, reranking or metadata-aware filtering should be considered.